

Experiment Log — Sprint 1: Customer Discovery

Venture: Parlance — AI conversation rehearsal for high-pressure communication
Date range: May 1–21, 2026
Experiment type: Problem validation / segment ranking
Submitted by: Team Parlance

Hypothesis

College students and job seekers experience the most acute pain around high-stakes verbal communication (interviews, presentations), and they would value a dedicated rehearsal tool over general writing/grammar AI.

Experiment Design

Element	Detail
Method	Semi-structured 20–30 min interviews (Zoom + in-person)
Sample	n=22 across 4 segments
Segments	College students (8), job seekers (7), neurodivergent communicators (4), immigrants/non-native speakers (3)
Recruitment	UNCW career center, LinkedIn posts, stuttering support communities, personal network
Questions	Last high-stakes conversation, current prep methods, willingness to practice with AI, privacy concerns, price sensitivity
Success metric	Rank segments by pain intensity (1–10) and stated intent to use

Results

Pain intensity by segment (self-reported, n=22)

Segment	Avg pain (1–10)	Would try AI rehearsal	Top use case

Job seekers	8.4	6/7 (86%)	Behavioral interview prep
College students	7.9	7/8 (88%)	Internship & class presentations
Neurodivergent	7.2	3/4 (75%)	Difficult conversations
Immigrants/NNS	6.8	2/3 (67%)	Networking & small talk

Key qualitative findings

1. **"I can write answers but freeze when speaking"** — cited by 16/22 participants
2. **Existing tools gap:** Grammarly/ChatGPT help with text; YouTube is passive; therapy apps feel clinical
3. **Privacy concern:** 14/22 asked "who sees my practice sessions?" before expressing interest
4. **Return intent:** 18/22 said they'd use weekly if it felt private and realistic

Segment ranking (decision)

1. **Job seekers** — highest urgency + clearest ROI (job = income)
2. **College students** — large accessible pool at UNCW, similar use case
3. Neurodivergent / immigrant segments — real need but more varied scenarios required

AI Leverage

- Used Claude to synthesize 22 interview transcripts into theme clusters in ~2 hours (vs. estimated 8+ hours manual)
- AI-generated follow-up question variants for next interview batch
- Prompt: *"Extract top 5 pain themes, segment differences, and direct quotes supporting each"*

Pivot / Learning

Original assumption: One product serves all segments equally.
Evidence: Job seekers and students share 80% of use cases (interview + presentation). Neurodivergent users need slower pacing options — deferred to v2.
Decision: MVP focuses on **job interview + presentation** scenarios for students/job seekers.

Risk assumptions tested

Assumption	Result
Users will practice with AI	✅ 82% expressed weekly use intent
Privacy is not a dealbreaker	⚠️ Conditional — local storage / no account strongly

	preferred
One product, multiple segments	 Partial — core overlap exists, edge cases differ

Rubric self-assessment

Pillar	Score (1–5)	Notes
Learning velocity	4	22 interviews in 3 weeks; clear segment ranking
Problem significance	5	Strong pain signals; underserved market gap validated
AI integration	4	AI accelerated synthesis; interviews were human-led
Venture progress	3	Pre-product → validated ICP
Responsible impact	4	Anonymized notes; no clinical claims
Coachability	4	Narrowed ICP based on data, not original breadth

Next experiment

Build Wizard-of-Oz MVP (Sprint 2) — scripted AI conversation via ChatGPT/Claude shared links. measure return rate after first session.